13 Creating a website with Razor Pages

This chapter covers

- Getting started with Razor Pages
- Introducing Razor Pages and the Model-View-Controller (MVC) design pattern
- Using Razor Pages in ASP.NET Core

So far in this book you've built one type of ASP.NET Core application: minimal API apps that return JavaScript Object Notation (JSON). In this chapter you'll learn how to build server-rendered, page-based applications using Razor Pages. Most ASP.NET Core apps fall into one of three categories:

- *An API designed for consumption by another machine or in code*—Web apps often serve as an API to backend server processes, to a mobile app, or to a client framework for building single-page applications (SPAs). In this case your application serves data in machine-readable formats such as JSON or Extensible Markup Language (XML) instead of the human-focused HTML output.
- *An HTML web application designed for direct use by users*—If the application is consumed directly by users, as in a traditional web application, Razor Pages is responsible for generating the web pages that the user interacts with. It handles requests for URLs, receives data posted via forms, and generates the HTML that enables users to view and navigate your app.